

NILS BLOSSEY

University of Cologne
Department of Political Science
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Last Updated: September 17, 2026

CURRENT POSITION

University of Cologne <i>Doctoral Researcher, Department of Political Science</i> Political Economy Lab	since October 2023
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EDUCATION

Cologne Graduate School in Management, Economics and Social Sciences <i>Doctoral Study Programme in Social Sciences, University of Cologne</i>	October 2023 - Present <i>Cologne</i>
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- Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Michael M. Bechtel
- Working Title: "Economic Origins of Electoral Conflict"

University of Amsterdam <i>Master of Science Political Science</i>	September 2022 - August 2023 <i>Amsterdam</i>
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- Specialization Track: Comparative Politics (GPA: 9.23/10, *with distinction*)
- Master Thesis: "Domestic Protection in World Markets: International Trade and Welfare State Development since the Nineteenth Century"

University of Münster <i>Bachelor of Arts Political Science and Economics</i>	October 2018 - September 2021 <i>Münster</i>
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- Specialization in Comparative Politics and Macroeconomics (GPA: 1.5)
- Bachelor Thesis: "Political Inequality in the Macroeconomic Policies and Electoral Participation in Developed Democracies"

PUBLICATIONS

Blossey, Nils (2025): Austerity and Social Spending: Estimating the Long-Run Effects of Fiscal Adjustment. *British Journal of Political Science* 55:e107. doi:10.1017/S0007123425000018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Electoral Politics, Historical Political Economy, Fiscal Policy, Welfare States, Redistribution, Survey Experiments

CURRENT PROJECTS

- From Wealth to Welfare: How Economic Elites Made Inequality Work (Accepted at Comparative Political Studies)
- *with Lukas Haffert and Lukas F. Stoetzer*: Coal Rush: The Built Legacy of the Industrial Revolution and the Rise of the Radical Right (Accepted at American Journal of Political Science)

- *with Paul Michel and Michael M. Bechtel*: Not in My Basement: The Political Consequences of Climate Reforms (Submitted)
- *with Lukas Haffert and Lukas F. Stoetzer*: Diversity and Socialism: Evidence from the Ruhr Diaspora
- *with Adrian Schröder*: Household Responses to Fiscal News Shocks
- Inner Mission, Outward Conquest: The Religious Coproduction of the Welfare State
- Hidden Champions *with Paul Michel, Jasmin Rath, and Jens Wäckerle*
- Democratic Breakdown and the Weimar Welfare State

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies

Research Assistant

April 2022 - September 2023

Cologne

- Research Group Political Economy (Prof. Dr. Lucio Baccaro) for Dr. Erik Neimanns

Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies

Research Intern

January 2022 - April 2022

Cologne

- Internship with Dr. Erik Neimanns
- Paper preparation: "From Media-Party Linkages to Ownership Concentration Causes of Cross-National Variation in Media Outlets' Economic Positioning"

University of Münster

Research Assistant

June 2020 - March 2022

Münster

- Research Assistant at the Chair of International Politics and Sustainable Development (Prof. Dr. Doris Fuchs)

Institute for Socioeconomics, University Duisburg-Essen

Research Intern

February 2021 - March 2021

Duisburg

- Internship with Prof. Dr. Paul Marx

City of Krefeld

Student Intern

January 2020 - March 2022

Krefeld

- Internship at the Municipal Integration Office Krefeld

Westdeutsche Zeitung Krefeld

Freelance Journalist

February 2016 - March 2019

Krefeld

- Culture and sports section

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

- Riederau Workshop on People's Understanding of and Support for Economic Policies: "Not in My Basement" September 2026
- 2nd Annual Sustainable Social Policy Workshop LSE: "Not in My Basement" June 2026
- In_equality Conference Konstanz 2026: "Diversity and Socialism" April 2026
- SPSA 2026: "Diversity and Socialism" January 2026
- DVPW Political Economy 2025: "Not in My Basement" September 2025
- APSA 2025: "Coal Rush" September 2025
- Junior Workshop in HPE, Madrid: "Coal Rush" July 2025

- EPSA 2025: "Coal Rush" July 2025
- SPSA 2025: "Social Protection and the Vote Against Democracy" January 2025
- EPSA 2024: "Deindustrialization and Electoral Realignment" July 2024
- In_equality Conference Konstanz 2024: "Wealth Inequality and Income Redistribution" April 2024
- Young ECONtribute Workshop: "Wealth Inequality and Income Redistribution" December 2023

TEACHING

- Quantitative Methods Laboratory (Graduate) 2024/5
- Research Design (Undergraduate) 2025
- Research Design (Graduate) 2025/6
- Causal Inference Teaching Assistant (Graduate) 2026
- Historical Political Economy (Undergraduate) 2026/7

GRANTS

- C-SEB Junior Starting Grant 2024 (4,000 Euros)

REVIEWING

Journal of the European Economic Association, Nature Communications, Political Science Research and Methods

AWARDS

- German Academic Scholarship Foundation September 2022 - August 2023
- Best Bachelor Thesis in Political Science, University of Münster August 2021

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Languages German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (upper intermediate), French (intermediate), Dutch (intermediate)